



King County Library System

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes

KCLS Service Center/Hybrid | February 25, 2026, 5pm

Present

KCLS Board

Crystal Goodwin
Jeffery Guddat
Harish Kulkarni
Srinu Raghavan
Laura Valenziano

KCLS Staff

Maria Bassett
Angie Benedetti
BJ Colvin
Heidi Daniel
Lisa Fraser
Chase Gallagher
Angie Miraflor
Dominica Myers
Danielle Perry
Cecie Streitman
Lisa Yamasaki
Donna Zirkle

Motions Approved

1. Board Meeting agenda
2. January 28, 2026 Board meeting minutes
3. Payroll expenditures
4. General Fund expenditures

Call to Order

President Laura Valenziano called the meeting to order at 5:03pm. Jeff Guddat, Srinu Raghavan, Harish Kulkarni and Crystal Goodwin attended in person. There was a quorum.

Approval of Agenda

Jeff Guddat moved approval of the Board Meeting agenda. Crystal Goodwin seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.

Approval of Board Minutes

Srinu Raghavan moved approval of the January 28, 2026 Board Meeting minutes. Harish Kulkarni seconded the motion. All voted in favor and the motion passed unanimously.

Public Comment

Willow Colvin, daughter of Information Technology Services Director BJ Colvin, spoke to the group about her love of KCLS libraries and shared the books she is currently reading.

Finance and Facilities Report

Finance and Facilities Director Donna Zirkle presented the Finance report as of the end of December 2025, the official close of the year. Total revenues for the year were \$153.9M, against the yearly revenue budget of \$150.6M which was approximately 102%. Total expenses were \$152.9M, which is 93% of the total expense budget of \$164.6M. CIP expenses at the end of December were \$9.4M accounting for 75% of the total budget of \$12.5M.

Despite an original forecast projecting a deficit of approximately \$14M, with budgeted revenues of \$150.6M and expenses of \$164.6M, KCLS closed the year with a surplus of approximately \$1M. Actual revenues totaled \$153.9M and actual expenses totaled \$152.9M.



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The favorable variance from the forecast was attributed to several factors on both the revenue and expenditure sides. On the revenue side, higher-than-expected investment returns and property tax receipts contributed to the improved position. On the expenditure side, vacancy savings and PERS benefit savings were well below projections. Additionally, a delay in the central sorter project shifted approximately \$3.1M in project costs from 2025 into 2026, further reducing 2025 expenditures.

Donna Zirkle closed her portion of the evening by presenting the monthly Finance report as of the end of January 2026. Year-to-date (YTD) revenues were \$400K, against the yearly revenue budget of \$155M, which was less than 1%. YTD expenses were \$14.3M, which is 9% of the total expense budget of \$165.4M. CIP expenses YTD at the end of January were \$118K accounting for 1% of the total budget of \$14.7M.

Approval of Monthly Expenditures

Jeff Guddat moved approval of Payroll expenditures for January in the amount of \$5,565,559.89:

(1/02) Ck#00202647-00202659; 184218645-184219792; (1/16) Ck#00202660-00202672; 194210114-194211285; (1/30) Ck#00202673-00202689; 201986132-201987280. **Srini Raghavan seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.**

Crystal Goodwin moved approval of General Fund #0010 expenditures for January in the amount of \$8,131,264.08: Travel Advances – 1562-1565; (1/08) Ck#5016031-5016032; 1164158-1164271; (1/15) Ck#5016033-5016071; 1164272-1164431; (1/22) Ck#5016072; 1164432-1164515; (1/28) Ck#1164516;

(1/30) Ck#5016073-5016076; 1164517-1164652; (2/05) Ck#5016077; 1164653-1164733. Voids - 0. **Harish Kulkarni seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.**

Staff and Director's Reports

Reimagining Library Spaces

Mona Zellers and Jack Chaffin from Johnston Architects presented an update on the Reimagining Spaces Initiative, a systemwide effort to modernize KCLS library facilities while maximizing the value of the existing building portfolio. The presentation covered the initiative's core goals, project road map, design guidelines, space-specific concepts for children's and teen areas, baseline and aspirational floor plan concepts for five branch locations, and proposed material palettes.

The six core goals framing the initiative are: modernizing library environments; improving access, equity, and inclusion; strengthening community connection; increasing flexibility and operational efficiency; advancing sustainability and system resilience; and establishing cohesive systemwide design guidance.



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The project road map encompasses five branch locations: Des Moines, Kent, Algona-Pacific, Southcenter, and Mercer Island. Design inputs include space diagrams, suggested modifications and furniture guidelines, and nature-inspired themes drawn from the Pacific Northwest environment, including Tide Pools, Rivers and Lakes, Animal Architecture, Erosion Patterns, and Canopies.

Design guidelines were organized across multiple space categories, including meeting and collaboration spaces, children's areas, teen areas, adult areas, service points, staff workspaces, and public areas. For each category, both baseline and aspirational design scenarios were presented.

The children's area framework is organized around five early literacy activities: Sing, Talk, Read, Write, and Play. Design recommendations address phonological awareness, vocabulary, print awareness, letter knowledge, and background knowledge, with corresponding spatial opportunities for each. Baseline recommendations include age-appropriate furniture, computer stations, cozy reading areas, and learning toys. Aspirational enhancements include fully enclosed program spaces, built-in seating and reading nooks, interactive wall elements, and scaled installations.

The teen area framework distinguishes between collaborative and independent modes of use, addressing small group study, hang-out spaces, book browsing, gaming, and individual research. Baseline design includes acoustic ceiling treatments, study pods, soft seating, flexible tables, and whiteboard surfaces. Aspirational enhancements include study nooks, a dedicated study room, operable partitions, stadium seating, and wall-mounted monitors.

Detailed existing conditions and aspirational floor-plan concepts were presented for the Kent branch, illustrating space and program limitations in the current configuration and proposed solutions addressing patron experience, staff visibility, accessibility, and equity.

Material concepts and palettes were presented for each of the five nature-inspired design themes, with specific finish and furniture recommendations for the Canopies palette, including flooring, wall treatments, ceiling elements, accent lighting, and furnishings.

Board Committee Reports

There were no Board committee reports.

Trustees Reports

Laura Valenziano reminded everyone of the KCLS Foundation Gala coming up on Saturday March 7. Jeff Guddat praised the partnership between KCLS and the KCLS Foundation.



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Adjournment

Laura Valenziano adjourned the meeting at 6:36pm.

Laura Valenziano, President

Jeff Guddat, Secretary
